Alejandro Benito-Santos

Permanent Professor, Department of Computer Languages and Systems, UNED

alejandro.benito.santos@gmail.com | alexbs.me | Madrid, Spain

General Information

Previous Position: Assistant Professor (Ayudante Doctor), UNED (2025-2026)

Research Areas: NLP, HCI, Information Visualization, and Digital Humanities

Awards and Research Leadership

2026 **CHI 2026 Best Paper Award**

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

"Chasing Meaning and/or Insight? A Survey on Evaluation Practices at the Intersection of Visualization and the Humanities."

First author; conceived the study, assembled an international team, and led the project over two years.

Paper

Education

2020 **PhD in Computer Engineering (International Doctorate)**

University of Salamanca

Thesis: Supporting Methodology Transfer in Visualization Research with Literature-Based Discovery and Visual Text Analytics.

Grade: Cum Laude.

2016 **MSc in Intelligent Systems**

University of Salamanca

MSc thesis: Data Visualization in Digital Humanities (highest distinction).

2008 **BEng Computer Engineering**

University of Salamanca

Academic Appointments

2026-present **Permanent Professor**

UNED, Department of Computer Languages and Systems

Permanent appointment since June 2026.

Teaching and research in NLP, visualization, and digital humanities.

2025-2026 **Assistant Professor (Ayudante Doctor)**

UNED, Department of Computer Languages and Systems

September 2025-June 2026.

2024-2025 **Juan de la Cierva Postdoctoral Researcher**

UNED, Department of Computer Languages and Systems

Research line: Visual Analytics for NLP Explainability and Fairness.

2022-2023 **Margarita Salas Postdoctoral Fellow**

University of Salamanca (GRIAL) and LINHD-UNED

2021 **Postdoctoral Researcher**

University of Salamanca, VisUSAL

2016-2020 **Researcher and Associate Lecturer**

University of Salamanca

Selected Publications

2026 **The Ruler and the Judge: Benchmark-Conditional Evaluation of LLM-as-a-Judge**
NeurIPS 2026, Evaluations and Datasets Track
Adrián Ghajari, Alejandro Benito-Santos, and Víctor Fresno. Accepted, to appear.

2026 **Chasing Meaning and/or Insight? A Survey on Evaluation Practices at the Intersection of Visualization and the Humanities**
ACM CHI
Alejandro Benito-Santos, Florian Windhager, Aida Horaniet Ibañez, Rabea Kleymann, Alfie Abdul-Rahman, and Eva Mayr. Best Paper Award.
Paper

2025 **Beyond Averages: Learning with Annotator Disagreement in STS**
EMNLP
Alejandro Benito-Santos and Adrián Ghajari.

2025 **Robust Estimation of Population-Level Effects in Repeated-Measures NLP Experimental Designs**
ACL, Volume 1 - Long Papers
Alejandro Benito-Santos, Adrián Ghajari, and Víctor Fresno.
Paper

Invited Talks and Seminars

June 2026 **Invited Keynote Speaker - Human Behind the Data**
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Getafe, Spain
Presented research as part of a panel on humanities, digital methods, and digital epistemologies.

May 2026 **Learning with Disagreements and Perspectivism in NLP**
MSc in Machine Learning, Public University of Navarre (UPNA), Pamplona, Spain
Lecture on disagreement, perspectivism, and the representation of diverse perspectives in natural language processing.
Talk

University Teaching

2023-2026 **Data Visualization (distance learning)**
UNED, MA in Digital Humanities
5 ECTS. Online teaching focused on visualization tools for complex data.

2024-2026 **Text Representation in Vector and Probabilistic Spaces (distance learning)**
UNED, MSc in Language Technologies
6 ECTS. Online teaching focused on embedding models.

2025-2026 **Programming Languages and Processors (distance learning)**
UNED, BSc in Information Technology Engineering
6 ECTS. Online teaching focused on the formal specification of programming languages.

2022-2023 **Data Visualization (distance learning)**
UNED, MSc in Data Science and Engineering
4 ECTS.

2022-2023 **Cloud Computing and Network Services Management (distance learning)**
University of Salamanca, MSc in Computer Engineering
4 ECTS.

2017-2018 **Informatica I**
University of Salamanca, BSc in Statistics
3 ECTS practical teaching in introductory programming and data structures.

2017-2018 **Human-Computer Interaction**
University of Salamanca, BSc in Computer Engineering
13.5 ECTS practical teaching; coordinator of "Interfaces Imaginadas".

2020-2022 **Python Programming and Computational Tools for Bioinformatics**
University of Salamanca, Diploma in Bioinformatics and Computational Genomics
Courses in Python programming and computational methods.

Advising and Teaching Innovation

- Co-supervisor of Adrián Ghajari Espinosa's PhD at UNED, with Víctor Fresno (since September 2024).
- Co-supervisor of Adrián Ghajari Espinosa's MSc thesis on semantic similarity in Spanish song lyrics (UNED, September 2024).
- Co-supervisor of David Eduardo Delgado Camacho's MSc thesis on a framework and visual analytics tool for exploring compositionality in sentence embeddings (UNED, June 2025).
- Director of UNED Summer Course 2024 on conversational AI (20 hours).
- Principal Investigator, teaching innovation project on online Python learning architecture (University of Salamanca, 2017-2018).
- Member, Innovation Group "Intelligent Systems for Learning" (UNED, since 2024).

Research Projects (Funded)

2022-2026 **ODESIA - Espacio de Observacion del Desarrollo del Español en la IA**
UNED / Red.es
National AI Strategy project. Participation in the leaderboard/evaluation line from 2024.

2022-2023 **CLS-INFRA - Computational Literary Studies Infrastructure**
Horizon 2020, INFRAIA-2020-1 (GA 101004984)

2018-2021 **PROVIDEDH - Progressive Visual Decision-Making in Digital Humanities**
CHIST-ERA (PCIN-2017-064)

2015-2019 **exploreAT! - Exploring Austria's Culture through the Language Glass**
Austrian Academy of Sciences / University of Salamanca

2014-2024 **Additional competitive and transfer projects**
University of Salamanca and collaborators
Includes projects in sports analytics, medical image machine learning, and technology transfer.

Service, Committees, and Recognition

- Co-chair, ODESIA-Challenge 2024 (international benchmark for Spanish LLM evaluation).
- Reviewer for ACL, EMNLP, Computational Linguistics, IEEE VIS, IEEE PacificVis, ACM CHI, IEEE Access, and JOCCH.
- Member of the VIS4DH scientific panel.
- Invited participant, Dagstuhl Seminar 23381 on Visualization and the Humanities (2023).
- ANECA accreditations (2023): Profesor Contratado Doctor (PCD), Profesor Ayudante Doctor (PAD), and Profesor de Universidad Privada.

International Visits and Professional Experience

2016-2023 **Research visits**
Austrian Academy of Sciences (Vienna), PSNC (Poznan), LINHD-UNED (Madrid)
STSM (ENeL/COST), predoctoral stay, and postdoctoral stay.

2011-2016 **Mobile software engineering and consulting**
Concise Media (London), Floxx (London), Victor Chandler (Gibraltar), Aurora Software (Madrid)
Industry experience in mobile application development and technology consulting.

Full publication list: alexbs.me/publications